

An Vo

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PhD student in Computer Science & Engineering @ University of Michigan
3944 BBB, University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, MI 48109, USA

BIOGRAPHY

An is a PhD student in Computer Science and Engineering at the [University of Michigan](#), advised by [Rada Mihalcea](#). His research focuses broadly on foundation models (LLMs/VLMs), with an emphasis on making them more trustworthy and explainable. He also collaborates closely with [Anh Totti Nguyen](#). Before joining Michigan, he worked as a Research Engineer at [MBZUAI](#) with [Thamar Solorio](#) and earned his MS from [KAIST](#), where he received the Outstanding Thesis Award and was fully funded by the [Hyundai CMK Global Scholarship](#).

EDUCATION

- **University of Michigan** Aug 2026 – May 2031 (expected)
PhD in Computer Science and Engineering | Advisor: [Rada Mihalcea](#) Ann Arbor, US
- **Korea Advanced Institute of Science & Technology (KAIST)** Feb 2024 – Feb 2026
M.S. in Computer Science | Advisor: [Daeyoung Kim](#) | Co-advisor: [Anh Totti Nguyen](#) Daejeon, South Korea
 - Thesis: Detecting and Understanding Biases in Foundation Models (*Outstanding Thesis Award*)
- **University of Information Technology (UIT), Vietnam National University HCMC** Aug 2019 – Apr 2023
B.S. in Computer Science | Advisor: [Ngoc Hoang Luong](#) Ho Chi Minh City, Vietnam
 - GPA: 9.32/10 (Valedictorian, #1)
 - Thesis: Many-Objective Evolutionary Neural Architecture Search with Performance Predictors (10/10–Best Thesis)

EXPERIENCE

- **University of Michigan** Aug 2026 – Present
Graduate Student Research Assistant (GSRA) Ann Arbor, US
 - Working on frontier ML/NLP problems
- **Mohamed bin Zayed University of Artificial Intelligence (MBZUAI)** Jan 2026 – Jul 2026
Research Engineer Abu Dhabi, UAE
 - Working on Multimodal LLMs, NLP with [Thamar Solorio](#)
 - Supporting the different research projects in the lab, contributing to research discussions and writing papers.
 - Engaging with the larger NLP and MBZUAI community
- **Korea Advanced Institute of Science & Technology (KAIST)** Feb 2024 – Jan 2025
Graduate Research Assistant Daejeon, South Korea
 - Broadly interested (but not limited to) in foundation models (e.g, LLMs, VLMs), especially in making them more trustworthy and explainable in rare/hard cases.
- **Auburn University** Mar 2024 – Jan 2025
Research Collaborator/Remote Visiting Student Remote
 - Remote collaboration with [Anh Totti Nguyen](#).
- **University of Information Technology (UIT), Vietnam National University HCMC** Apr 2020 – Jan 2024
Undergraduate Research Assistant Ho Chi Minh City, Vietnam
 - Conducted research on Evolutionary Computation, Neural Architecture Search (NAS), Vehicle Routing Problem, and Multi-Objective Optimization.
 - Developed novel algorithms to enhance the efficiency of NAS using evolutionary and other optimization algorithms.
- **ZaloPay, VNG Corporation** Jul 2023 – Sep 2023
Associate Data Scientist Ho Chi Minh City, Vietnam

- Led development of a Customer Lifetime Value (CLV) prediction system for 5M ZaloPay users, leveraging XGBoost/LightGBM and advanced financial feature engineering.
- Improved user segmentation and retention strategies by enabling more accurate value prediction and targeted engagement initiatives.

• Eximbank

Software Engineer

May 2023 – Jul 2023

Ho Chi Minh City, Vietnam

- Developed core banking modules to enhance system functionality and support business operations.
- Engineered database-ready features enabling efficient data extraction and analytics for the business team.

PUBLICATIONS

C=CONFERENCE, J=JOURNAL, P=PREPREPRINT

* indicates equal contribution.

Conference papers

- [C.1] An Vo*, Vy Tuong Dang*, Khai-Nguyen Nguyen, Emilio Villa-Cueva, Thamar Solorio†, Anh Totti Nguyent†, Daeyoung Kim† (2026). Deep and shallow biases in language models. The 2026 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP 2026). [[project website](#)]
- [C.2] Vy Tuong Dang*, An Vo*, Emilio Villa-Cueva, Quang Tau, Duc Dm, Thamar Solorio, Daeyoung Kim (2026). VMMU: A Vietnamese Multitask Multimodal Understanding and Reasoning Benchmark. *Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: ACL-IJCNLP 2026*. [[paper](#) | [project website](#)]
- [C.3] Thao Do, Dinh Phu Tran, An Vo, Seon Kwon Kim, Daeyoung Kim (2026). EnComp: Lightweight Encoder-Only Context Compression for Retrieval-Augmented Question Answering. *The 5th Asia-Pacific Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics & the 15th International Joint Conference on Natural Language Processing (ACL-IJCNLP 2026)*. [[paper](#)]
- [C.4] An Vo*, Khai-Nguyen Nguyen*, Mohammad Reza Taesiri, Vy Tuong Dang, Anh Totti Nguyent†, Daeyoung Kim† (2025). Vision Language Models are Biased. The Fourteenth International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR 2026). [[paper](#) | [project website](#)]
- [C.5] Gabriel Manalu, An Vo, Duc Dm, Quang Tau, Nguyen Dinh Son, Minh Son Hoang, Hyeontaek Hwang, Jaesung Lee, Hyojin Choi, Tuan Phong Tran, Daeyoung Kim (2026). RADBench: Evaluating Foundation VLMs for Corner Case Description on A Comprehensive Dataset. *The IEEE Intelligent Vehicles Symposium (IV 2026)*. [[paper](#)]
- [C.6] An Vo, Mohammad Reza Taesiri, Daeyoung Kim, Anh Totti Nguyen (2025). B-score: Detecting biases in large language models using response history. *Forty-Second International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML 2025)*. [[paper](#) | [project website](#)]
- [C.7] Thao Do, Dinh Phu Tran, An Vo, Daeyoung Kim (2025). Reference-Based Post-OCR Processing with LLM for Precise Diacritic Text in Historical Document Recognition. *Annual AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence (AAAI 2025)*. [[paper](#) | [code](#) | [dataset](#)]
- [C.8] An Vo, Ngoc Hoang Luong (2024). Efficient Multi-Objective Neural Architecture Search via Pareto Dominance-based Novelty Search. *Genetic and Evolutionary Computation Conference (GECCO 2024)*. [[paper](#) | [code](#)]
- [C.9] Nhat Minh Le*, An Vo*, Ngoc Hoang Luong (2024). Zero-Cost Proxy-Based Hierarchical Initialization for Evolutionary Neural Architecture Search. *IEEE Congress on Evolutionary Computation (CEC 2024)*. [[paper](#)]
- [C.10] Khoa Huu Tran, Luc Truong, An Vo, Ngoc Hoang Luong (2023). Accelerating Gene-pool Optimal Mixing Evolutionary Algorithm for Neural Architecture Search with Synaptic Flow. *Genetic and Evolutionary Computation Companion Conference (GECCO Companion 2023)*. [[paper](#) | [code](#)]
- [C.11] An Vo, Tan Ngoc Pham, Van Bich Nguyen, Ngoc Hoang Luong (2022). Training-Free Multi-Objective and Many-Objective Evolutionary Neural Architecture Search with Synaptic Flow. *International Symposium on Information and Communication Technology (SoICT 2022)*. **Best Paper Award**. [[paper](#) | [code](#)]

Journal papers

- [J.1] An Vo, Nhat Minh Le, Ngoc Hoang Luong (2026). Lightweight Multi-Objective and Many-Objective Problem Formulations for Evolutionary Neural Architecture Search with the Training-Free Performance Metric Synaptic Flow. *SN Computer Science*. [[paper](#) | [code](#)]
- [J.2] Ngoc Hoang Luong, Quan Minh Phan, An Vo, Tan Ngoc Pham, Dzung Tri Bui (2024). Lightweight Multi-Objective Evolutionary Neural Architecture Search with Low-Cost Proxy Metrics. *Information Sciences*. [[paper](#) | [code](#)]
- [J.3] An Vo, Tan Ngoc Pham, Van Bich Nguyen, Ngoc Hoang Luong (2023). Efficient Multi-Objective Neural Architecture Search via Tree Search with Training-Free Metrics. *Informatica*. [[paper](#) | [code](#)]

SELECTED GRANTS AND FELLOWSHIPS

In PhD Program

- 2026: Rackham Conference Travel Funding (for EMNLP 2026) – \$1150

In M.S. Program

- 2025: Hyundai CMK Global Scholarship of Excellence (for ICML 2025 paper acceptance) – \$2200
- 2025: Hyundai CMK International Symposium Scholarship (ICML 2025 travel grant) – \$1500
- 2025: Cohere Labs Research Grant (with Vy Tuong Dang) – \$2,000
- 2025: Together AI Research Grant – \$150
- 2024: OpenAI Research Grant – \$2,500
- 2024: Cohere For AI Research Grant – \$1,000
- 2024–2026: KAIST Fellowship – \$22,000 (estimated total value)
- 2024–2026: Hyundai Chung-Mong Koo Global Scholarship – \$45,000 (estimated total value)

In B.S. Program

- 2022–2023: Incentive for Scientific Publications – \$100
- 2019–2023: University of Information Technology, VNU-HCM Merit Scholarships – \$3,600 (estimated total value)

In High School

- 2016–2019: Incentive for Participation and Awards in High School Olympiads – \$1,000 (estimated total value)

SELECTED HONORS AND AWARDS

In M.S. Program

- Outstanding M.S. Thesis Award

In B.S. Program

- 2023: **Valedictorian** of the B.S. Program
- 2023: Excellent Graduate of the B.S. Program
- 2022: **Best Paper Award** at the International Symposium on Information and Communication Technology (SoICT)
- 2022: Ho Chi Minh City Outstanding Youth
- 2022: Award for Outstanding Scientific Research Publications
- 2019: Top 100 Student Leaders of Ho Chi Minh City
- 2019–2023: Recognized for Excellence in Academics and Personal Development

In High School

- 2019: Consolation Prize in the Provincial Science and Engineering Fair
- 2018: First Prize in the Provincial Youth Informatics Competition
- 2018: First Prize in the Provincial English-Language Science and Engineering Competition in Informatics
- 2018–2019: Competed in the National Olympiad in Informatics (VOI) x2
- 2017–2018: Second Prize in the Provincial Olympiad in Informatics x2
- 2017: Bronze Medal in the Summer Olympiad in the Mekong Delta in Informatics
- 2017: Bronze Medal in the April 30th Olympiad in Informatics
- 2017: Consolation Prize in the Provincial Physics Olympiad via Internet

SELECTED PRESS COVERAGE

Industry Usage

- 2026: Moonshot AI – [Used VLMs are Biased as a source benchmark for developing PerceptionBench.](#)
- 2026: Alibaba Qwen – [Used VLMs are Biased to evaluate Qwen3.8.](#)
- 2026: ByteDance – [Used VLMs are Biased to evaluate Seed 2.0.](#)
- 2025: ByteDance – [Used VLMs are Biased to evaluate Seed 1.8.](#)
- 2025: Google DeepMind – [Used VLMs are Biased to evaluate Gemini 3 Pro.](#)
- 2025: Moondream – [Used examples from VLMs are Biased to demonstrate reduced counting bias through grounded reasoning.](#)

News Coverage

- 2026: [Vision Language Models are Biased](#) is featured in this Sky News [film](#) and [article](#) discussing the role of AI in modern warfare and its potential dangers.

Articles & Blog Posts

- 2026: KAIST School of Computing – [ICLR 2026 paper reveals memorization bias and limitations in counterfactual reasoning in vision-language models.](#)
- 2025: Gary Marcus – [GPT-5: Overdue, overhyped and underwhelming](#)
- 2025: Hacker News (Vision Language Models are Biased) – [Front page](#)

MENTORING

Undergraduate Students at University of Information Technology, Vietnam National University–Ho Chi Minh City

- **Khoa Huu Tran** (Oct 2022 – Jan 2024) – [GECCO Late-Breaking Abstract Paper](#)
- **Luc Truong** (Oct 2022 – Jan 2024) – [GECCO Late-Breaking Abstract Paper](#)
- **Minh Le** (Oct 2022 – Feb 2023) – [IEEE CEC Paper](#)
- **Vy Tuong Dang** (Dec 2021 – Aug 2025) – KAIST Scholarship for M.S. Program (Full Tuition Fee & Stipend) & [VMMU](#)

SELECTED PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

- **Conference Reviewer/Program Committee:** [NeurIPS 2026](#), [AAAI 2026](#), [BMVC 2025](#)
- **Journal Reviewer:** [IEEE Transactions on Evolutionary Computation](#)

TALKS

- 2024: **AutoID Labs Asia Workshop 2024** – Efficient Multi-Objective Neural Architecture Search via Pareto Dominance-based Novelty Search.
- 2022: **SoICT 2022** – Training-Free Multi-Objective and Many-Objective Evolutionary Neural Architecture Search with Synaptic Flow.

SELECTED CERTIFICATES

- 2025: IELTS 7.0 Overall (Exam date: 11 Oct 2025)
- 2023: TOEIC 880 (Exam date: 04 Mar 2023)
- 2021: Computational Thinking for Problem Solving – University of Pennsylvania, Coursera
- 2021: Linear Algebra for Machine Learning and Data Science – DeepLearning.AI, Coursera
- 2021: Python for Data Science and AI – IBM, Coursera
- 2021: Improving Deep Neural Networks: Hyperparameter Tuning, Regularization and Optimization – DeepLearning.AI, Coursera
- 2021: Neural Networks and Deep Learning – DeepLearning.AI, Coursera
- 2021: Fundamentals of Reinforcement Learning – University of Alberta, Coursera

- 2021: Sample-based Learning Methods – University of Alberta, Coursera
- 2020: How Google Does Machine Learning – Google Cloud, Coursera
- 2020: What is Data Science? – IBM, Coursera
- 2020: Basic Statistics – University of Amsterdam, Coursera
- 2020: Machine Learning – Andrew Ng, Stanford University, Coursera

REFERENCES

Dr. Rada Mihalcea

Michigan AI Director & Professor at UMich
mihalcea at umich.edu

Dr. Daeyoung Kim

Professor at KAIST
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Dr. Thamar Solorio

Vice Provost & Professor at MBUIAI
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Dr. Anh Totti Nguyen

Associate Professor at Auburn University
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Dr. Mohammad Reza Taesiri

Research Scientist at EA SPORTS
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Dr. Ngoc Hoang Luong

Head of AI Dept & Lecturer at UIT, VNU-HCM
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